

drive kilometres away from your destination in order to find a parking spot *sigh*. Forgetful souls can mark their parking spot on Google Maps by simply tapping the blue dot that shows your current location and then selecting 'Set as parking location' from the pop-up menu that opens up. The marker stays right there on Maps and you can now easily navigate your way back to your vehicle when you're ready to leave.

EASILY ACCESS MUSIC CONTROLS

If you've usually got Google Maps open while driving around or simply walking, you can add a nifty music



Add music controls to Google Maps

widget to it in order to control music playback without ever leaving the app. Google Maps allows you to sync some music apps including Google Play Music, Apple Music, YouTube Music and Spotify. To enable this, head over to Settings and then go to Navigation settings. Now, click on 'Show media playback controls' on Android, or 'Music playback controls' on iOS. A pop-up will prompt you to select your default media app. Select it and hit Next. Now, whenever navigation begins on Maps, you will see an icon of the music

app on the right-hand side of the screen. Click on it to expand and control playback. You can even tap on Browse at the bottom of the screen and access your playlists on Google Play Music.

APPLE MAPS

Before Apple Maps arrived in 2012 for iOS devices, Google Maps was the default navigation app for iOS. However, while Apple entered the GPS and navigation territory with Apple Maps, the app was never as popular as its Google counterpart and had its fair share of ups and downs. Nevertheless, with the introduction of the overhauled Apple Maps app with iOS 13, it has certainly gotten much better and more popular than before. Here are some tips and tricks to get the best out of Apple Maps.

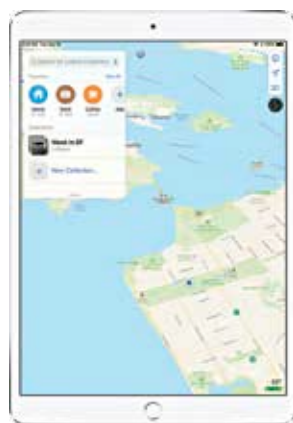
LOOK AROUND

Similar to Google Maps' Street View feature, Apple has a Look Around feature. Unfortunately, it isn't as ubiquitous as Google Maps' Street View and can only be used in a select few locations in the US, as of now. Hopefully, it will make its way to other countries soon. However, if you are visiting the US, you can try out this feature on your Apple device. When a location has the Look Around feature

available, you will see the blue point indicating your current location turn into blue binoculars. Tap that and you will be able to see a close-up street view of the location in a tiny card at the top of the window. You can tap the card to view the street in full screen and then use your finger to navigate around the area.

CREATE A COLLECTION LIST

You can now create a Collections list where you can incorporate your favourite locations such as restau-



Add your favourite locations to a Collection list and share it with your friends

rants, parks, tourist locations, and more. The collections list can also be shared with your friends and family. To get started, open up Apple Maps (running iOS 13 or iPadOS 13 or higher). Now, swipe up from the bottom

of the screen to expand the menu and click on 'New Collection' under the Favourites section. Tap 'Add a place' and search for locations you want to add to the list and then click on 'Done' when you have added all locations. You can, of course, keep adding to the list whenever you desire. You can also add places from a normal search on Apple Maps by clicking on the 'Add to' button and selecting the corresponding Collection list. Now, tap the Share button at the bottom of the Collection page to share it with anyone in your contact list via a messaging app or email.

DROP A PIN

Dropping a pin in Apple Maps allows users to quickly visualise the distance between their current location and the 'pinned' location. You can also quickly get directions to the pinned location. To drop a pin on Apple Maps, tap and hold your destination and a red-coloured pin will appear on the map. Now, in addition to getting directions to the pinned location, you can also find out its exact geographic coordinates, and add the location to your favourites and rename it anything you want (gym, xxx's home, supermarket, etc) for easy future access. You can even map this location to an existing contact or share the pinned location via messages, email or even Twitter. To remove a pin, tap on the pin and then click on Edit Location. Now, simply tap Remove Marker.

AVOID TOLLS AND HIGHWAYS

If you want to cut costs down by avoiding routes with tolls, Apple Maps can be adjusted to provide alternative routes.

